

of a diesel locomotive to an electric one in 69 days at half the cost. Additionally, the railways commissioned the longest electrified tunnel in the country at 6.6 km in Andhra Pradesh in 2019.

The process of electrification continues even today with the aim to create a zero carbon-emitter railway within the next decade or so.

ORGANIZING RAILWAY ELECTRIFICATION

In the 1950s, the Project Office for Railway Electrification (PORE) was set up in Calcutta to monitor the electrification of the Howrah–Bardhaman section. It merged with the Main Line Electrification Project the following year under a general manager headquartered in Calcutta, and administered the Eastern and South Eastern Railways projects. It was decommissioned in 1968 after work came to an end. The Northern Railway Electrification office, under an engineer-in-chief, was constituted in 1961 at Allahabad, Uttar Pradesh for the Mughalsarai–New Delhi section. A specialized organization came up in 1978 after the J Raj Committee submitted its report, which led to the creation of the Central Organisation for Railway Electrification (CORE). Headquartered in Nagpur, Maharashtra, till 1984 and then Allahabad, its mission is the successful and effective execution of all railway electrification projects.



▲ **Rolled out in 1983-84**, the first phase of the Chennai Mass Rapid Transit System (MRTS) included the 8.55-km-stretch from Chennai Beach to Thirumayilai, crossing the Chennai Fort. This suburban passenger service uses Electrical Multiple Units (EMUs), which are fast and cause less pollution.